

Victor Rangel

Senior Economist | Causal Inference, Applied Economics, and Data Science

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Professional Profile

Economist with a master's degree in Public Policy from Insper and a background in data science, applied econometrics, causal inference, and decision-oriented analytics. Experienced in structuring, cleaning, and analyzing datasets from multiple sources, including Brazilian administrative data, using Python, R, SQL, Stata, NLP, machine learning, dashboards, and analytical pipelines. Applied research spanning public policy, regulation, digital finance, political behavior, stock returns, and language models. Focused on developing information products, experimenting with LLMs, communicating results clearly, and designing quantitative solutions for economic, political, legal, and regulatory issues.

Selected Professional Experience

Founder and Content Creator 2022 – Present
Econometria Fácil Brazil

- Founded Econometria Fácil, an educational project focused on econometrics, causal inference, and data analysis, with more than 200,000 followers.
- Columnist for *Folha de S.Paulo*, writing about evidence, public policy, data, and public debate.
- Designs courses and hands-on workshops in R, Python, Stata, causal inference, applied econometrics, and quantitative research workflows.

Master's-Level Research Assistant 2024 – 2025
Insper São Paulo, SP

- Worked on health economics and public policy evaluation projects, applying causal inference and panel-data methods and re-estimating empirical findings with modern difference-in-differences estimators.

Research Assistant 2023
FGV IBRE – Brazilian Institute of Economics Rio de Janeiro, RJ

- Worked on an econometric project for Brazil's National Department of Transport Infrastructure (DNIT), developing the research design, collecting data, and implementing causal inference models to evaluate infrastructure policies.

Data Scientist 2023
Senac – National Department Rio de Janeiro, RJ

- Developed a labor-market analysis project integrating national administrative datasets, including RAIS and CAGED, with real-time job-posting data.
- Built predictive models to support decisions on educational offerings and demand for workforce training.

Senior Data Scientist 2021 – 2023
Sovos Compliance, LLC São Paulo, SP

- Led the development of an automated tax-document processing system using NLP and machine learning.
- Architected ETL pipelines on AWS, using version-control and CI/CD practices, and collaborated with international teams to analyze regulatory and legislative documents.

Consultant 2020 – 2023
Downstream Advisors, Inc. Dallas, TX / Remote

- Developed market-intelligence solutions for oil and gas companies, including automated data collection, interactive dashboards, and spatial analysis to support strategic logistics and expansion decisions.

Education

Master's Degree in Public Policy 2024 – 2026
Insper São Paulo, SP

Graduate-Level Econometrics Course, Non-Degree Student 2021
Federal University of Espírito Santo Vitória, ES

Bachelor's Degree in Economics 2015 – 2020
FUCAPE Business School Vitória, ES

Selected Research and Technical Work

- The Difference of Different Difference-in-Differences: Evidence from Health Economics Applications** 2026
Master's thesis, Professional Master's Program in Public Policy, Insper. Advisors: Cristine Pinto and Pedro H. C. Sant'Anna. Reassesses difference-in-differences applications in health economics and compares conventional TWFE estimators with estimators robust to treatment-effect heterogeneity.
- Environmental Enforcement and Abnormal Stock Returns: Causal Evidence from Brazil** 2026
Forthcoming in *Brazilian Review of Finance*; accepted at the 26th Brazilian Finance Meeting. Uses a causal research design to estimate the effects of environmental enforcement on abnormal stock returns in Brazil.
- Masking the Identification Problem: How Time Aggregation Manufactures Cross-Country Evidence—A Comment on Tausk & Spira (2025), *BMC Public Health*** 2026
Forthcoming in *Journal of Comments and Replications in Economics*. Shows how time aggregation can produce misleading cross-country comparative evidence and obscure identification problems in applied public health research.
- From Association to Explanation: Strengthening Research Design and Causal Reasoning in Accounting Scholarship** 2026
Forthcoming in *Advances in Scientific and Applied Accounting*. Discusses how accounting studies can move from associational evidence to causal explanations through research design, identification strategies, and greater clarity in inference.
- Regulatory Simplification, Formalization, and Local Economic Activity: Evidence from Brazil** Submitted
Estimates how local regulatory simplification affects firm formalization and municipal economic activity.
- Economic Conditions and Voting Behavior** 2025
Public Choice. Examines how local economic conditions shape voting choices, linking economic performance, local shocks, and political behavior.
- Assessing Political Bias and Value Misalignment in Generative Artificial Intelligence** 2025
Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization. Tests whether generative AI systems express political preferences or value profiles that differ from those of various user groups.
- Natural Disasters and Financial Technology Adoption** 2025
Economics Letters. Studies whether exposure to natural disasters changes demand for digital financial services and accelerates fintech adoption.
- Government, Taxation and Economic Complexity** 2024
Applied Economics Letters. Investigates how government activity and tax structures relate to the economic complexity of countries and regions.
- More Human than Human: Measuring ChatGPT Political Bias** 2024
Public Choice. Measures the political orientation of ChatGPT responses and compares the model's results with patterns observed in human survey data.
- Bonus for Firearms Seizures and Police Performance** 2022
Economics Letters. Evaluates whether bonuses for firearm seizures affect police behavior and public-safety indicators.
- Economic Complexity and Corporate Governance** 2022
Applied Economics Letters. Explores the relationship between the sophistication of local economies and firm-level corporate-governance practices.

Tools and Methods

Econometrics	Causal inference, modern DiD, RDD, IV, synthetic control, panel data, time series, and quasi-experimental design.
Programming	Python, R, SQL, Stata; Pandas, scikit-learn, tidyverse, fixest, NLTK; Git, CI/CD, and automation.
Data and ML	ETL, AWS, NLP, LLMs, supervised learning, web scraping, data visualization, dashboards, and geospatial analysis.
Communication	Technical writing, policy briefs, applied teaching, documentation, presentations, and translation of quantitative results into actionable insights.